

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

The handbook is organized as a numbered policy manual. The page references below are intended to be refreshed after final pagination in Microsoft Word.

Update the Table of Contents in Word to refresh page numbers.

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

Field	Details
Document	Aurigin Media Employee Handbook
Version	1.0
Effective Date	To be inserted
Policy Owner	Human Resources / Management
Business Location	Delhi
Applies To	Employees and full-time consultants, subject to applicable terms
Classification	Internal & Confidential
Review Cycle	At least annually and whenever material policy/legal changes occur

Policy Status

This handbook is intended to provide a clear and consistent framework for employment, workplace conduct, people practices and operational expectations at Aurigin Media. It should be read together with the employee's Offer Letter, Appointment Letter and any specific written policy or communication applicable to the employee.

Policy Supremacy

Where an individual employment document or a mandatory requirement of applicable law provides a different entitlement or obligation, the applicable legal requirement and the employee's executed contractual terms will govern to the extent required.

Policy Amendment

Aurigin Media reserves the right to review, amend, replace, suspend or withdraw policies based on business requirements, operational changes, management decisions or applicable law. Material changes will be communicated through the Company's official channels.

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DEFINITIONS

1 GENERAL POLICIES AND PROCEDURES

1.1 Welcome

Welcome to Aurigin Media. We are a Delhi-based social media, digital marketing, creative and influencer marketing organization. Our work depends on ideas, execution, collaboration, responsiveness and trust. Every employee contributes to the quality of the work delivered to clients and to the reputation of Aurigin Media.

1.2 Introduction

This Employee Handbook provides a common reference for workplace standards, employment practices, benefits, leave, performance, conduct, information security, client responsibilities and separation. It is designed to reduce ambiguity and help employees understand how work is expected to be conducted.

1.3 Purpose

The purpose of this handbook is to establish consistent people and workplace practices while supporting a professional, respectful, collaborative and high-performing environment.

1.4 About Aurigin Media

Aurigin Media operates across Social Media, Digital Marketing, Creative and Influencer Marketing. The nature of the business requires employees to work with client information, creative assets, publishing platforms, campaign timelines, creators, vendors and digital tools. Accordingly, professional judgment, confidentiality, accuracy and timely escalation are essential.

1.5 Vision, Mission & Values

Area	Aurigin Media Framework
Vision	To build a creative, responsible and high-performing digital environment where strong ideas and disciplined execution create meaningful brand impact.
Mission	To deliver thoughtful social, digital, creative and influencer marketing solutions that meet client needs while maintaining quality, integrity and professional standards.
Values	Ownership • Creativity • Collaboration • Integrity • Respect • Client Trust • Accountability • Continuous Improvement

1.6 Scope & Applicability

The handbook applies to employees and full-time consultants, subject to the terms of their engagement. Certain policies may apply differently based on role, location, employment status, contractual terms or applicable law.

1.7 Terms of Employment

The employee's Offer Letter and Appointment Letter contain the specific contractual terms of employment. Employees are expected to read those documents carefully and maintain confidentiality of their individual employment records and terms. This handbook provides general policy guidance and does not replace an executed employment agreement.

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1.8 Employment Categories

- Probationary employees: employees undergoing the initial assessment period specified in their employment documents.
- Confirmed / regular employees: employees who have successfully completed probation and received confirmation, where applicable.
- Other engagement categories: temporary, contractual or consultant arrangements may be governed by their specific written terms.

1.9 Working Days

The regular working schedule is Monday to Friday, with a standard work week of 40 hours excluding reasonable rest intervals.

1.10 Weekly Holidays

Saturday and Sunday are the normal weekly holidays, subject to business requirements, client commitments and any approved work arrangements.

1.11 National & Festival Holidays

Aurigin Media will communicate the applicable holiday calendar for each calendar year. The calendar may take account of national holidays, public holidays and relevant festival holidays.

1.12 Working Hours

Normal working hours are 10:00 a.m. to 7:00 p.m., subject to business, client and team requirements. Employees are expected to remain available and responsive during agreed working hours and to communicate any planned unavailability in advance.

1.13 Hybrid / Remote Work

Hybrid or remote working may be permitted based on role, business requirements, performance, client commitments and management approval. Remote work is a working arrangement and not an automatic entitlement. Employees working remotely remain subject to the same standards of availability, confidentiality, productivity, conduct and client service as employees working from the office.

1.14 Policy Administration

Employees are responsible for understanding and complying with applicable policies. Managers are responsible for applying policies consistently and escalating material concerns to HR/Management.

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2 CODE OF CONDUCT & PROFESSIONAL ETHICS

Purpose

To establish the standards of professionalism, integrity, honesty, respect and responsible conduct expected from everyone working with Aurigin Media.

Scope

This policy applies across all levels and functions and applies in the office, during remote work, at client locations, on business travel, at company events and in digital communication.

Policy Guidelines

- Act honestly, fairly and responsibly in all business dealings.
- Treat colleagues, clients, creators, vendors and partners with dignity and respect.
- Protect Aurigin Media's reputation, assets, information and business opportunities.
- Respect cultural, personal and professional differences.
- Use sound judgment in communications, decisions and use of company resources.
- Comply with applicable laws, contractual obligations and Company policies.
- Do not misrepresent facts, records, performance, expenses, attendance or client deliverables.
- Do not use Company information or opportunities for unauthorized personal benefit.

2.1 Dress & Grooming

Employees should maintain clean, appropriate and professional attire suited to the workplace, role, client interaction and business occasion. Employees meeting clients or representing Aurigin Media externally may be expected to adopt a more formal standard. Reasonable accommodation will be made for religious, cultural, disability or other lawful requirements.

2.2 Unacceptable Behaviour & Misconduct

- Verbal, written or physical abuse; threats or intimidation.
- Discrimination, harassment, bullying or victimization.
- Theft, fraud, falsification or deliberate misuse of records.
- Unauthorized disclosure of confidential or client information.
- Unauthorized access to accounts, systems or data.
- Use or possession of prohibited substances at work or work-related events, subject to applicable law.
- Deliberate damage, misuse or negligent handling of Company or client property.
- Unauthorized public statements on behalf of Aurigin Media.
- Use of Company resources for illegal, offensive, harassing or inappropriate activity.
- Retaliation against a person who raises a concern in good faith.
- Failure to cooperate with an authorized investigation or audit.

2.3 Conflict of Interest

Employees must avoid situations where personal interests conflict, or reasonably appear to conflict, with the interests of Aurigin Media. Outside employment, consulting, business activities or roles involving a competitor, client, supplier or other relevant third party require prior written approval where they could create an actual or perceived conflict.

2.4 Gifts & Hospitality

Employees must not accept or offer money, benefits or gifts intended to improperly influence business decisions. Reasonable business courtesies may be acceptable where lawful, transparent and modest, but employees should seek guidance from HR/Management when in doubt.

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2.5 Workplace Relationships

Personal friendships are not prohibited. Employees must nevertheless maintain professional boundaries and avoid favoritism, conflicts of interest, disruption, retaliation or conduct that makes others uncomfortable. Romantic relationships must not compromise reporting integrity, decision-making, performance management or hiring.

2.6 Manager-Subordinate Relationships

Managers must not use their position to pursue, pressure or disadvantage an employee in connection with a personal or romantic relationship. Any relationship that creates an actual or perceived conflict with reporting, appraisal, promotion, compensation, scheduling or hiring must be disclosed to HR/Management for appropriate safeguards.

2.7 Visitors

Visitors should be appropriately authorized and must follow office security and confidentiality requirements. Visitors must not be permitted into restricted areas or access confidential information.

2.8 Company Identity & Brand Assets

Company logos, letterheads, trademarks, templates and stationery are to be used only for authorized business purposes.

2.9 Smoking / Substance Use

Company premises are non-smoking areas. Employees must not report to work or participate in Company activities while impaired by alcohol or prohibited substances, or possess prohibited substances at the workplace, subject to applicable law.

2.10 Office Cleanliness & Resource Conservation

Employees are expected to maintain clean work areas and use electricity, water, equipment and other resources responsibly.

2.11 Fair Dealing

Employees must deal fairly with colleagues, clients, vendors, creators, competitors and other stakeholders and must not obtain advantage through manipulation, misrepresentation, abuse of privileged information or other unfair practices.

2.12 Fraud & Financial Integrity

Records and transactions must be accurate, complete and supported by appropriate documentation. Any suspected fraud, falsification or financial irregularity must be reported promptly.

2.13 Improper Business Opportunity

Employees must not divert Company opportunities, clients, leads, suppliers, creators or business prospects for unauthorized personal benefit or for another business.

2.14 Records & Audits

Employees must maintain accurate records relevant to their responsibilities and cooperate with legitimate audits, reviews and investigations.

2.15 Lobbying / External Representation

No employee may represent Aurigin Media in political, regulatory or public advocacy matters unless specifically authorized.

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2.16 Reporting Unethical or Illegal Behaviour

Employees should promptly raise serious concerns with their manager, HR or another appropriate member of Management. Good-faith reporting will not result in retaliation.

2.17 Whistleblower / Speak-Up

Serious concerns involving fraud, financial reporting, unlawful conduct, material policy violations, data misuse or conduct capable of materially harming the Company should be raised promptly. Complaints will be handled sensitively and, to the extent reasonably possible, confidentially.

2.18 Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Employees	Understand policies, act professionally, protect information/assets, report concerns and cooperate with investigations.
Managers	Model expected conduct, communicate standards, respond to concerns and escalate material issues to HR/Management.
HR / Management	Maintain policy governance, investigate or coordinate investigations, apply corrective measures and maintain appropriate records.

2.19 Consequences

Policy violations may result in counselling, training, written warning, performance or conduct action, suspension where appropriate, termination or other action consistent with the seriousness of the matter and applicable law.

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3 OFFICE EQUIPMENT & ASSET USAGE POLICY

Purpose

To protect Company property and ensure responsible, cost-effective and secure use of equipment and resources.

Scope

All employees and authorized users receiving Company equipment or access.

Policy Guidelines

- Use Company assets primarily for legitimate business purposes.
- Take reasonable care of laptops, desktops, phones, cameras, storage devices, access cards, software and other assigned assets.
- Do not install unauthorized software or disable security controls.
- Do not lend Company equipment or credentials to unauthorized persons.
- Report loss, theft, damage or malfunction promptly.
- Maintain equipment in a condition appropriate for return at separation.

Asset Allocation & Records

HR/Administration/IT or the designated custodian may maintain an asset register identifying the asset, serial number, employee, date of allocation and return status.

Loss / Damage

Where loss or damage results from negligence, misuse, unauthorized use or deliberate conduct, the Company may take appropriate recovery or disciplinary action, subject to applicable law and due process.

Return of Assets

All Company assets, documents, access cards, keys, storage devices and other materials must be returned as part of the exit clearance process.

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4 HUMAN RESOURCE POLICY

Purpose

To establish consistent processes for recruitment, employee records, onboarding, probation, attendance and employment administration.

Scope

All employees, subject to their contractual terms.

Policy Guidelines

- Employment decisions should be based on role requirements, capability, experience, business need and fair consideration.
- Information provided during recruitment and employment must be accurate and complete.
- Employee records should be maintained accurately and updated when material personal information changes.
- HR records will be treated as confidential and accessed only for legitimate business, statutory or employment purposes.
- Employees must complete required joining documentation and policy acknowledgements.

4.1 Recruitment & Selection

Aurigin Media seeks to select candidates based on role requirements, capability, relevant experience, potential, professional conduct and organizational needs. No employee may make an unauthorized commitment regarding employment terms.

4.2 Application Accuracy & Background Verification

Material misrepresentation, falsification or omission in an application, resume, qualification, employment history or other required document may result in withdrawal of the offer or disciplinary action, subject to applicable law.

4.3 Employment Records & Privacy

Employees must promptly inform HR of material changes to contact details, emergency contacts, bank information, identification documents or other required records. HR will maintain only information necessary for employment administration, legal compliance and legitimate business purposes.

4.4 Employee Orientation

New employees should receive an orientation covering the Company, role, workplace expectations, policies, confidentiality, client responsibilities, security, benefits and required documentation.

4.5 Probation

The standard probationary period is six months unless the Offer/Appointment Letter specifies otherwise. The period may be curtailed or extended based on performance, conduct, business requirements and management assessment. Confirmation is subject to satisfactory completion and formal communication.

4.6 Notice During Probation

During probation, the standard notice period for voluntary separation is 30 days unless the employee's employment document specifies otherwise.

4.7 Attendance & Punctuality

Regular attendance and punctuality are essential. Employees should mark attendance in the Company's designated manual Excel attendance record and promptly communicate delays or absence to their reporting manager. Repeated unauthorized lateness or absence may lead to corrective action.

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4.8 Excessive Absenteeism

Employees are expected to attend work as scheduled. Where illness or emergency prevents attendance, the employee should inform the reporting manager as early as reasonably possible.

4.9 Absconding / Job Abandonment

Unauthorized absence beyond the applicable threshold, without communication or response to Company notices, may be treated as potential job abandonment. The Company may issue written notices and conduct appropriate proceedings before taking final action, subject to applicable law.

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5 COMPENSATION & BENEFITS POLICY

Purpose

To provide a transparent framework for salary administration and employee benefits without unnecessarily disclosing individual or internal compensation arrangements.

Scope

Employees according to their employment terms and eligibility.

Policy Guidelines

- Individual compensation is governed by the employee's Offer/Appointment Letter and applicable Company processes.
- Salary and benefits are administered through authorized payroll processes.
- Employees must provide accurate information required for payroll and statutory compliance.
- Statutory deductions and benefits will be handled in accordance with applicable law and eligibility.
- Certain benefits may vary by role, employment status, tenure, policy or business arrangement.

5.1 Salary Cycle & Pay Day

The Company will process salary through its established monthly payroll cycle. The applicable payment date and payroll cut-off may be communicated through HR/Finance and may be subject to banking and statutory requirements.

5.2 Compensation Confidentiality

Employees should treat their individual compensation documents and HR/payroll records as confidential and should not access or disclose another employee's compensation information without authorization.

5.3 Overtime / Additional Work

Additional work performed outside normal hours or on holidays should be undertaken only where business requirements and prior approval require it. Eligibility for overtime or compensatory arrangements, where applicable, will be determined by Company policy, employment terms and applicable law.

5.4 Bonus / Incentives

Any bonus, incentive, variable pay or special award will be governed by the applicable written scheme, eligibility conditions, performance requirements and management approval.

5.5 Retention Bonus

Where a retention incentive is specifically offered in writing, its amount, period, eligibility, payment conditions and any repayment provisions will be governed by that written arrangement. A retention payment is not an automatic entitlement unless expressly provided.

5.6 Gratuity

Gratuity will be administered in accordance with applicable law and the employee's eligibility.

5.7 Expense Reimbursement

Business expenses that are ordinary, necessary, reasonable and directly related to Company business may be reimbursed subject to prior approval, applicable limits and submission of valid supporting documentation.

5.8 Statutory / Other Deductions

The Company may make statutory deductions and other authorized deductions in accordance with applicable law, employment terms and approved Company arrangements.

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6 LEAVE & TIME-OFF POLICY

6.1 Purpose

To establish consistent leave entitlements and administration for eligible regular employees.

6.2 Scope

This policy applies to regular employees. Entitlements during probation and for other categories are subject to the provisions stated in the applicable employment documents and this policy.

6.3 Leave Year

The leave year runs from 1 April to 31 March.

6.4 Probation

Leave applicable during probation is accounted for in accordance with the Company's leave administration and may be availed after successful completion of probation, subject to the applicable policy and legal requirements.

Leave Type	Entitlement	Application	Key Conditions
Earned / Privilege Leave	1.5 days per calendar month	7 days advance	Up to 10 days carry forward; maximum accumulation 30 days; maximum 15 days at a stretch with approval
Casual Leave	7 days per leave year	2 days advance; 1 week where more than 2 days	Paid; lapses at year-end
Sick Leave	7 days per leave year	As soon as reasonably possible	Medical certificate may be required after 3 continuous days
Optional / Restricted Holiday	2 paid working days per leave year	Prior approval	For eligible regular employees; subject to holiday calendar
Menstrual Leave	12 paid days per leave year; generally 1 day/month	As reasonably practicable	May be clubbed with other leave; no carry forward
Marriage Leave	5 days	Prior approval	Use within 6 months of marriage
Paternity Leave	5 days	Prior approval / notification	To be used within 15 days of childbirth; subject to policy eligibility
LWP	Up to 15 days in exceptional cases	Management approval	Unpaid; exceptional circumstances
Compensatory Off	4 hours = half day; 8+ hours = full day	Prior approval to work on holiday	Use within 60 days; maximum 3 consecutive days

6.5 Earned Leave

- Earned Leave is credited at 1.5 days per calendar month.
- Leave should normally be requested at least 7 days in advance.
- Employees should avail at least 8 days during the leave year; unused leave may be carried forward up to 10 days, subject to the maximum accumulation of 30 days.
- Maximum 15 days may be taken continuously with prior approval.
- Eligible balance at separation will be dealt with in accordance with applicable law and Company policy.

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6.6 Casual Leave

- Maximum 7 days in the leave year.
- Casual Leave is paid and does not carry forward.
- Requests should normally be made 2 days in advance; requests exceeding 2 days should preferably be made one week in advance.
- Leave exceeding 4 days may be administered as Earned Leave where appropriate.

6.7 Sick Leave

- Maximum 7 days in the leave year.
- Medical evidence may be requested where absence exceeds 3 continuous days.
- Prolonged illness may require medical documentation and a discussion with HR regarding appropriate leave arrangements.

6.8 Menstrual Leave

- Up to 12 paid days in the leave year, generally one day per month.
- May be clubbed with other eligible leave.
- Unused menstrual leave is not carried forward or encashed.
- Reasonable flexibility may be discussed where work arrangements permit.

6.9 Maternity Leave

Maternity benefits will be administered in accordance with applicable maternity legislation and applicable state rules. The Company will provide the statutory entitlement applicable to an eligible employee, including provisions relating to maternity leave, adoption/commissioning arrangements and medically supported circumstances, as applicable.

6.10 Paternity Leave

Eligible regular male employees are entitled to 5 days of paternity leave, subject to the Company's eligibility conditions, generally to be taken within 15 days of childbirth and at a stretch.

6.11 Compensatory Off

- Prior manager approval is required to work on a declared holiday/off day.
- Minimum 4 hours of approved work may qualify for half-day comp-off; 8 hours or more may qualify for one full day.
- Comp-off should normally be used within 60 days.
- Not more than 3 consecutive days should be availed at one time.

6.12 Leave Procedure

- Leave requires prior approval except in genuine emergencies.
- Employees should apply through the Company's designated manual process and ensure the manager has approved the leave.
- Emergency absence should be communicated to the reporting manager at the earliest and regularized after return.
- Intervening holidays/weekly offs will be treated according to the applicable leave rule.
- Overstaying approved leave without authorization may be treated as unauthorized absence or LWP.
- More than 7 days of unauthorized absence without communication may trigger the job-abandonment process.

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7 EMPLOYEE REFERRAL POLICY

Purpose

To encourage employees to recommend suitable candidates and support quality hiring.

Scope

Regular full-time employees, subject to the exclusions below.

Policy Guidelines

- Referral must be submitted with the employee's name and employee code.
- The referring employee must not participate in the selection decision for the referred candidate.
- The first valid referrer will be considered where duplicate referrals occur.
- A referral will not qualify where the candidate is already in the Company's recruitment database or otherwise known to HR before the referral.

7.1 Referral Bonus

Eligible employees may receive a total referral incentive of ₹8,000 for a successful referral: ₹4,000 after the referred employee completes three months of employment and ₹4,000 after completion of probation, subject to eligibility and applicable deductions.

7.2 Exclusions

The policy does not apply to employees on notice period, contractual employees or designated senior management/department heads. Management may determine eligibility where unusual circumstances arise.

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8 PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT & PERFORMANCE IMPROVEMENT PLAN

Purpose

To create a fair, structured process for setting expectations, providing feedback and supporting employees whose performance requires improvement.

Scope

All employees, with processes adapted to role, level and employment stage.

Policy Guidelines

- Performance expectations should be communicated clearly and should relate to role responsibilities, goals, quality, timeliness, collaboration and professional conduct.
- Managers should provide timely feedback rather than waiting for formal review cycles.
- Employees should have an opportunity to understand expectations, ask questions and seek reasonable support.
- Performance decisions should be based on evidence and applied fairly.

8.1 PIP

A Performance Improvement Plan may be initiated where an employee's performance materially falls below reasonable expectations and additional structure is required. A PIP is intended to provide clarity, support, measurable expectations and a defined review process; it is not automatically a disciplinary action.

8.2 PIP Process

- Identify specific performance gaps with examples.
- Define the expected performance standard.
- Set measurable improvement objectives.
- Identify training, coaching or other support.
- Set review dates and feedback frequency.
- Document progress and employee responses.
- Communicate potential outcomes if improvement is not achieved.

8.3 Possible Outcomes

A PIP may be successfully closed, extended where justified, converted into another development arrangement or may lead to further employment action where performance remains materially below expectations.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

9 TRAVEL & EXPENSE POLICY

Aurigin Media recognizes that official travel may be required for client meetings, events, shoots, conferences, seminars and other business activities. Employees are expected to travel responsibly and use Company funds prudently.

9.1 Travel Approval

- All official travel must be approved by the reporting manager/authorized management before booking.
- Travel advances should be requested with sufficient lead time and approved before release.
- Employees should select reasonable and cost-effective options consistent with business requirements.

9.2 Expense Documentation

- Original or valid digital bills, invoices, tickets, boarding passes and other supporting documents should be submitted.
- Expense claims should ordinarily be submitted within 7 days of return from official travel.
- Unused travel advances should be returned promptly, ordinarily within 10 days of return.

9.3 Meals

The standard meal reimbursement limit is ₹350 per meal. Any amount above the prescribed limit requires prior/exceptional management approval and supporting justification.

9.4 Local Travel

- Employees should arrange reasonable point-to-point travel for approved official requirements.
- Own-vehicle reimbursement is ₹8/km for two-wheelers and ₹12/km for four-wheelers, subject to applicable approval and documentation.
- Cab bookings should normally be made in advance and should avoid unnecessary waiting charges.
- Client-chargeable local travel should have appropriate client approval where required.

9.5 Non-Reimbursable Expenses

- Personal reading material.
- Airline/hotel club memberships.
- In-room or in-flight entertainment.
- Tobacco, cigarettes and liquor.
- Personal expenses not directly related to approved business travel.

9.6 False Claims

False, inflated or fabricated expense claims may result in recovery and disciplinary action, up to and including termination depending on seriousness.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

10 EXIT & SEPARATION POLICY

10.1 Purpose

To ensure an orderly, professional and secure separation process while protecting the interests of both the employee and Aurigin Media.

10.2 Resignation

Resignation must be submitted in writing to the reporting manager with HR copied, identifying the proposed last working day. The resignation becomes effective upon receipt and formal processing in accordance with Company procedure.

10.3 Notice Period

The standard notice period is 60 calendar days for confirmed employees unless the employee's appointment terms specify otherwise. During probation, the standard notice period is 30 days.

10.4 Notice Waiver / Early Release

Management may approve waiver, reduction or early release from notice based on business requirements and the employee's handover status.

10.5 Handover

- Complete current task and project status.
- Provide client/account context and pending actions.
- Transfer relevant documents, files, credentials and access through authorized channels.
- Complete knowledge transfer to the designated person.
- Return Company and client property.
- Ensure no Company/client information remains in personal storage.

10.6 Exit Clearance

Full and final settlement and separation documents will be processed after completion of applicable clearance, asset return, handover and other required formalities. Recovery of legitimate outstanding amounts may be made as permitted by law and the employee's contractual terms.

10.7 Exit Interview

HR may conduct an exit interview to understand the employee experience, identify improvement opportunities and capture constructive feedback.

10.8 Termination

Aurigin Media may terminate employment in accordance with the employment contract, applicable law and appropriate process for reasons including serious misconduct, material policy violation, fraud, data theft, confidentiality breach, repeated unauthorized absence, serious insubordination, or sustained performance concerns.

10.9 Job Abandonment

Where an employee remains absent without authorization or communication, the Company may issue notices requiring the employee to report or explain the absence. Further action may follow based on the response and applicable process.

10.10 Final Documents

Relieving, experience and other separation documents will be issued subject to completion of applicable clearance and Company procedures.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

11 SOCIAL MEDIA, CLIENT ACCOUNT & DIGITAL PUBLISHING POLICY

Purpose

To protect Aurigin Media, its clients and their brands from unauthorized publication, information leakage, account compromise, reputational harm and publishing errors.

Scope

All employees and consultants involved in social media, digital, creative, influencer, client servicing, account management or any role with access to social platforms.

Policy Guidelines

- Only authorized employees may access or operate Company/client social accounts.
- Credentials, passwords, OTPs, access links and recovery information are confidential and must never be shared outside authorized channels.
- Content must follow the applicable client brief, brand guidelines, approval workflow and publishing instructions.
- Employees must not publish, delete, edit, boost or otherwise modify client content outside their authorized role.
- Unpublished campaigns, drafts, content calendars, performance data, influencer rates and client discussions are confidential.
- Do not post screenshots of client dashboards, internal chats, drafts, credentials, campaign previews or restricted work.
- Media or public enquiries regarding Aurigin Media or a client should be referred to an authorized spokesperson.
- Any publishing mistake, account compromise, accidental disclosure or suspicious access must be escalated immediately.
- Employees remain responsible for content and comments published from their personal accounts and must not disclose confidential Company or client information.

11.1 Personal Social Media

- Personal accounts must not be represented as official Aurigin Media accounts unless authorized.
- Employees discussing work or the industry should make clear when opinions are personal where relevant.
- Do not publish confidential, defamatory, discriminatory, threatening, harassing, obscene or illegal material relating to Company/client work.
- Do not disclose financial, pricing, future campaign, unreleased product or client strategy information.

11.2 Client Accounts & Credentials

- Access should be provided only through authorized account-management mechanisms where available.
- Never store client passwords in personal notes, personal email or unapproved applications.
- Never forward OTPs or recovery links to unauthorized persons.
- Access should be removed promptly when role requirements change or employment ends.

11.3 Content Approval & Publishing

- Follow the client-specific approval workflow.
- Verify copy, creative, tags, links, dates, offers, handles and campaign settings before publishing.
- Where a second-person check is required, obtain it before publication.
- Do not bypass an approval process because of urgency without explicit authorized approval.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

11.4 Publishing Incident

If incorrect content is published, an employee must not conceal the error. Immediately inform the reporting manager/client servicing lead or designated escalation contact, preserve relevant evidence and follow the corrective action plan.

11.5 Photography & Screenshots

Do not photograph or publish confidential documents, client work, screens, security features, employees, creators or third parties without appropriate permission.

11.6 Portfolio / Showcase

Employees may not publish client work, campaign results, drafts, internal processes or unreleased creative work in a personal portfolio or public profile without appropriate authorization and confirmation that the work is cleared for public use.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

12 CLIENT CONFIDENTIALITY & INFORMATION SECURITY POLICY

Purpose

To safeguard confidential information belonging to Aurigin Media, its clients, employees, creators, vendors and business partners.

Scope

All employees, regardless of function or work location.

Policy Guidelines

- Confidential information must be used only for legitimate work purposes.
- Access must be limited to information required for the employee's role.
- Do not forward confidential material to personal email or unauthorized storage.
- Use strong, unique passwords and required authentication controls.
- Do not share credentials or allow unauthorized persons to use logged-in devices.
- Use approved Company channels for work information.
- Exercise caution with phishing, unknown links, attachments and requests for credentials.
- Report suspected security incidents immediately.

12.1 Confidential Information

Confidential information includes client briefs, strategies, content calendars, unpublished creatives, proposals, pricing, contracts, influencer terms, performance reports, account credentials, internal communications, employee data, financial information and other non-public business information.

12.2 Passwords & MFA

- Passwords must not be shared.
- MFA must not be disabled where enabled.
- OTP, recovery codes and authentication links are confidential.
- If a credential is exposed, report it immediately so access can be secured.

12.3 Email & Messaging

Official email and approved communication channels should be used for business information. Employees should verify unexpected requests for money, credentials, sensitive files or urgent account changes through an independent channel.

12.4 Cloud Storage

Company/client information must be stored only in authorized repositories. Personal cloud drives, personal messaging applications and unapproved file-sharing services must not be used for confidential work.

12.5 Personal Devices / BYOD

Where personal devices are permitted for work, employees must maintain reasonable security, avoid storing confidential information unnecessarily, use screen locks and promptly report loss or compromise.

12.6 Security Incident

Examples include phishing, accidental email to the wrong person, lost device, credential exposure, unauthorized account access, malware, accidental public posting or suspected data leakage. Report immediately to the reporting manager/authorized security or management contact.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

12.7 Offboarding

On transfer or separation, employees must return or delete Company/client information from personal devices or locations where permitted and cooperate with access removal and credential transition.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

13 AI & GENERATIVE AI POLICY

Purpose

To establish responsible principles for the use of generative AI and similar tools in Company work.

Scope

All employees using AI tools in connection with Aurigin Media work.

Policy Guidelines

- AI outputs must be treated as assistance, not as automatically accurate or approved work.
- Employees remain responsible for accuracy, quality, confidentiality, copyright and client obligations.
- Do not enter confidential client information, personal data, credentials, unpublished campaigns or sensitive Company information into unapproved AI tools.
- Do not use AI to create or manipulate content in a manner that is deceptive, unlawful or inconsistent with client instructions.
- Review AI-generated copy, images, video, code or analysis before use.
- Check third-party rights, licensing and originality before publishing.
- Follow client-specific instructions regarding AI usage.

13.1 Confidentiality

Where a tool's data-handling terms are not approved by the Company or client, confidential information must not be entered into that tool.

13.2 Human Review

Employees must review AI outputs for factual accuracy, tone, brand compliance, bias, copyright concerns, unintended claims, sensitive information and suitability for the intended audience.

13.3 Creative & Synthetic Media

AI-generated or AI-edited images, voices, videos and other synthetic media must not be used deceptively or in violation of client, platform or legal requirements. Appropriate disclosure or approval should be obtained where required.

13.4 Accountability

Use of an AI tool does not transfer responsibility for the final deliverable from the employee or Company to the tool provider.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

14 DATA PRIVACY & EMPLOYEE INFORMATION POLICY

Purpose

To protect employee and stakeholder personal information and support responsible handling of personal data.

Scope

All employees who collect, access, use or manage personal information.

Policy Guidelines

- Collect and use personal information only for legitimate and authorized purposes.
- Keep personal information accurate and update records when changes are notified.
- Restrict access to those who need it for legitimate work.
- Do not disclose employee, client, creator or vendor personal information without authorization.
- Use reasonable security measures to protect personal information.
- Report suspected privacy incidents promptly.

14.1 Employee Data

Employee data may include identification, contact, payroll, attendance, leave, performance, benefits, emergency contact and other employment-related information.

14.2 Retention & Access

Records will be retained for periods appropriate to employment administration, business requirements and applicable law. Access is limited based on role and legitimate need.

14.3 Third Parties

Where personal information must be shared with authorized service providers, payroll partners, insurers, statutory bodies or other legitimate recipients, the Company may share the information necessary for the relevant purpose.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

15 INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY, COPYRIGHT & CREATIVE ASSETS POLICY

Purpose

To protect creative work, intellectual property and third-party rights in the Company's social, digital, creative and influencer marketing operations.

Scope

All employees and consultants involved in creating, editing, managing or approving content or other work product.

Policy Guidelines

- Use only content, music, images, fonts, templates, software and other assets that are appropriately licensed or authorized.
- Do not copy or repurpose third-party creative work without permission or a lawful basis.
- Maintain records of relevant licences and approvals where required.
- Client-specific ownership and usage rights must be respected.
- Company work product must be stored in authorized repositories.
- Employees must not use confidential or client work for personal gain.

15.1 Work Product

Work created in the course of employment for Company/client assignments may be subject to contractual ownership and client agreements. Employees should not assume that they may independently reuse such work.

15.2 Portfolio Use

Public use of client work in a portfolio requires appropriate authorization and must respect client confidentiality, embargoes and contractual restrictions.

15.3 Third-Party Content

Before publishing third-party material, employees must ensure the necessary permissions, licences, attribution or other rights are available.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

16 REMOTE & HYBRID WORK POLICY

Purpose

To provide a structured framework for approved remote/hybrid work while maintaining productivity, client service, confidentiality and team collaboration.

Scope

Employees approved for remote or hybrid work.

Policy Guidelines

- Remote work requires manager/management approval and may be reviewed based on business needs.
- Employees must remain available during agreed working hours.
- Employees must maintain a suitable workspace and reliable connectivity.
- Confidential work must be conducted in a manner that prevents unauthorized viewing or access.
- Client meetings, shoots, events or other business requirements may require office or on-site presence.
- Remote work does not reduce performance, availability or conduct expectations.

16.1 Attendance

Employees must follow the Company's attendance and availability process even while working remotely. Unavailability should be communicated in advance except in emergencies.

16.2 Security

Use screen locks, secure networks, authorized storage and appropriate privacy measures. Avoid discussing confidential client information in public places.

16.3 Review

Aurigin Media may modify, suspend or withdraw remote/hybrid arrangements where client commitments, performance, security, collaboration or business requirements make this necessary.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

17 WORKPLACE RESPECT, EQUAL OPPORTUNITY, POSH & GRIEVANCE POLICY

17.1 Equal Opportunity

Aurigin Media is committed to fair and respectful employment practices. Employment decisions should be based on legitimate role and business requirements, qualifications, capability, performance and other relevant factors, without unlawful discrimination.

17.2 Non-Discrimination

Discrimination, harassment or victimization based on protected characteristics or any other prohibited ground under applicable law is not acceptable.

17.3 Bullying & Harassment

Harassment may include unwanted physical, verbal, written or non-verbal conduct that violates dignity or creates an intimidating, hostile, degrading, humiliating or offensive environment. Bullying may include sustained intimidating, insulting, malicious or abusive conduct, including misuse of power.

17.4 Examples

- Unwelcome sexual comments or advances.
- Offensive messages, emails or social-media content.
- Threats, shouting, humiliation or intimidation.
- Deliberate exclusion or professional sabotage.
- Derogatory comments about personal characteristics.
- Unwanted physical conduct.
- Retaliation or victimization.

17.5 POSH

Sexual harassment complaints will be handled in accordance with the applicable law governing prevention, prohibition and redressal of sexual harassment of women at the workplace. Aurigin Media will maintain the required Internal Committee / designated mechanism and communicate the applicable contact details to employees.

17.6 Complaint Procedure

- An employee may raise a concern with HR, the reporting manager or the designated Internal Committee/contact, depending on the nature of the matter.
- Where an informal resolution is appropriate and safe, the employee may communicate that the conduct is unwelcome; however, an employee is not required to confront the alleged person.
- Formal complaints will be handled through an appropriate process with confidentiality and sensitivity.
- Investigations will be conducted by appropriately authorized persons without prior involvement where reasonably practicable.
- Relevant parties will be informed of outcomes to the extent permitted by law and confidentiality requirements.

17.7 Non-Retaliation

Good-faith complainants, witnesses and participants in investigations must not be subjected to retaliation or victimization. Retaliation may itself result in disciplinary action.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

17.8 Grievance Redressal

Employees may raise concerns about workplace practices, managers, working conditions, policy interpretation or other employment matters with HR or an appropriate senior person. HR will acknowledge and assess concerns and determine the appropriate route for resolution.

17.9 POSH Committee Details

Internal Committee Chairperson: [TO BE INSERTED]

Internal Committee Members: [TO BE INSERTED]

External Member: [TO BE INSERTED]

Official Complaint Channel: [TO BE INSERTED]

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

18 ANTI-BRIBERY, GIFTS, HOSPITALITY & BUSINESS ETHICS POLICY

Purpose

To prevent improper influence and protect objective business decision-making.

Scope

All employees and representatives of Aurigin Media.

Policy Guidelines

- Never offer, promise, request or accept a bribe or improper benefit.
- Do not make facilitation payments or unofficial payments to obtain a business advantage.
- Business gifts and hospitality must be reasonable, lawful, transparent and unrelated to improper influence.
- Disclose potential conflicts involving vendors, clients, creators or partners.
- Keep appropriate records of business expenses and benefits where required.
- Report suspected bribery or improper conduct promptly.

18.1 Influencer / Creator Relationships

Commercial arrangements with creators, influencers, talent representatives and vendors must be based on approved business terms. Employees must not accept personal commissions, kickbacks, gifts or benefits in connection with such arrangements.

18.2 Reporting

Concerns should be reported to HR/Management or through the Speak-Up mechanism.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

19 WORKPLACE HEALTH, SAFETY & WELL-BEING POLICY

Purpose

To support a safe, respectful and healthy working environment.

Scope

All employees and persons present at Aurigin Media workplaces or participating in Company activities.

Policy Guidelines

- Follow reasonable workplace safety instructions.
- Report hazards, accidents, injuries or unsafe conditions promptly.
- Maintain office hygiene and safe workspaces.
- Use electrical and office equipment responsibly.
- Do not obstruct emergency exits or safety equipment.
- Take reasonable care during official travel, shoots, events and client activities.

19.1 Emergency Response

Employees should follow building emergency procedures and instructions of authorized personnel during fire, medical, security or other emergencies.

19.2 Well-being

Aurigin Media encourages respectful communication, reasonable workload planning and early escalation of issues affecting an employee's ability to perform safely and effectively.

19.3 Incident Reporting

Workplace incidents, injuries, threats, security incidents or material hazards should be reported to the reporting manager/HR/Administration without undue delay.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

20 DISCIPLINARY & CORRECTIVE ACTION POLICY

20.1 Purpose

To provide a fair and proportionate framework for addressing misconduct, policy violations and serious performance or conduct concerns.

20.2 Principles

- Fairness and consistency.
- Opportunity to explain concerns where appropriate.
- Confidential handling on a need-to-know basis.
- Proportionate action based on seriousness and circumstances.
- No retaliation for good-faith reporting.

20.3 Corrective Action

- Counselling or coaching.
- Written warning.
- Mandatory training.
- Performance or conduct improvement plan.
- Suspension or other interim measures where appropriate and lawful.
- Termination or other separation action.

20.4 Investigation

The Company may investigate complaints, policy breaches, data incidents, financial irregularities, misconduct or other concerns. Employees are expected to cooperate honestly and preserve relevant information.

20.5 Show Cause / Domestic Enquiry

Where warranted by the circumstances and applicable law, the Company may issue a show cause notice or conduct a domestic enquiry before taking final disciplinary action.

20.6 Serious / Gross Misconduct

- Fraud or theft.
- Serious confidentiality or data breach.
- Unauthorized access to client/company accounts.
- Intentional falsification of records.
- Serious harassment or violence.
- Serious insubordination.
- Deliberate damage or misuse of Company/client property.
- Other conduct of comparable seriousness.

20.7 Representation

Employees may provide their explanation, evidence or relevant information during an applicable process. The Company will consider the available facts before reaching a decision.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

21 EMPLOYEE COMMUNICATION & RECORDS POLICY

Purpose

To ensure that important employment and business information is communicated through reliable channels and retained appropriately.

Scope

All employees.

Policy Guidelines

- Use official Company channels for employment, operational and client communications.
- Employees should read and respond to official HR communications within reasonable timelines.
- Do not alter, delete or conceal records that are required for business, legal or audit purposes.
- Maintain accurate project, client, financial and HR records relevant to your role.
- Respect confidentiality when forwarding or storing internal communications.

21.1 Official Communication

Email, authorized collaboration tools, official HR communication and approved messaging channels may be used for Company communications. Employees should not rely solely on informal verbal messages for material decisions or approvals.

21.2 Policy Acknowledgement

Employees may be required to acknowledge receipt and understanding of this handbook and other policies.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

22 MANAGER & EMPLOYEE RESPONSIBILITIES

Employee Responsibilities	Manager Responsibilities
Read and understand applicable policies.	Set the example through professional conduct.
Meet role, quality and timeline expectations.	Communicate clear expectations and priorities.
Protect client and Company information.	Protect confidential information and client relationships.
Raise concerns promptly.	Respond appropriately to employee concerns.
Maintain accurate records and attendance.	Apply policies consistently and document material issues.
Complete required handovers.	Support development, feedback and performance improvement.
Cooperate with investigations.	Escalate serious conduct/security matters to HR/Management.

22.1 HR Responsibilities

- Maintain the handbook and policy governance.
- Support consistent employment administration.
- Maintain appropriate employee records.
- Coordinate investigations and grievance processes.
- Support managers with performance and conduct matters.
- Communicate material policy changes.

22.2 Leadership Responsibilities

- Set organizational standards.
- Ensure business practices align with applicable law and Company values.
- Provide resources for effective policy implementation.
- Review policies periodically.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

23 GENERAL POLICY ADMINISTRATION

23.1 Interpretation

HR/Management will provide administrative interpretation of this handbook. Interpretation will be applied consistently with applicable law and contractual obligations.

23.2 Exceptions

Exceptions require appropriate management approval and, where relevant, HR review. An exception for one employee does not automatically create a precedent for another.

23.3 Legal Compliance

Nothing in this handbook is intended to reduce any statutory right or obligation. Where applicable law requires a more favorable entitlement or process, the legal requirement will apply.

23.4 Policy Changes

Aurigin Media may update policies to reflect business changes, operational learning, technology, client requirements or changes in law.

23.5 Confidentiality

This handbook is an internal document. Employees should not circulate it externally unless authorized.

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

24 ANNEXURES

Annexure A — Leave Quick Reference

Leave	Entitlement	Advance Notice / Key Rule
Earned / Privilege Leave	1.5 days per calendar month	7 days advance

Leave	Entitlement	Advance Notice / Key Rule
Earned / Privilege Leave	1.5 days per calendar month	7 days advance Up to 10 days carry forward; maximum accumulation 30 days; maximum 15 days at a stretch with approval
Casual Leave	7 days per leave year	2 days advance; 1 week where more than 2 days Paid; lapses at year-end
Sick Leave	7 days per leave year	As soon as reasonably possible Medical certificate may be required after 3 continuous days
Optional / Restricted Holiday	2 paid working days per leave year	Prior approval For eligible regular employees; subject to holiday calendar
Menstrual Leave	12 paid days per leave year; generally 1 day/month	As reasonably practicable May be clubbed with other leave; no carry forward
Marriage Leave	5 days	Prior approval Use within 6 months of marriage
Paternity Leave	5 days	Prior approval / notification To be used within 15 days of childbirth; subject to policy eligibility
LWP	Up to 15 days in exceptional cases	Management approval Unpaid; exceptional circumstances
Compensatory Off	4 hours = half day; 8+ hours = full day	Prior approval to work on holiday Use within 60 days; maximum 3 consecutive days

Annexure B — Travel Quick Reference

Item	Guideline
Meal	₹350 per meal
Own 2-wheeler	₹8/km
Own 4-wheeler	₹12/km
Expense submission	Normally within 7 days of return
Travel advance balance	Normally return within 10 days
Approval	Prior approval required

Annexure C — HR Details To Be Inserted

Item	Details
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HR Contact	[TO BE INSERTED]
HR Email	[TO BE INSERTED]
POSH Internal Committee	[TO BE INSERTED]
Emergency Contact	[TO BE INSERTED]
IT / Security Contact	[TO BE INSERTED]
Attendance / Leave Process	Manual Excel / designated HR process
Holiday Calendar	Issued annually

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

EMPLOYEE ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I acknowledge that I have received access to the Aurigin Media Employee Handbook. I understand that I am responsible for reading and complying with the policies applicable to my employment and role. I understand that the handbook provides general policy guidance and should be read together with my employment documents and applicable law.

Employee Details

Employee Name _____

Employee ID _____

Designation _____

Department _____

Date of Joining _____

Date of Acknowledgement _____

Employee Signature: _____

Date: _____

For HR / Management: _____

Date: _____

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

HR IMPLEMENTATION CHECKLIST

Before formal release of this handbook, HR/Management should complete the following items:

- Confirm legal entity and registered address details.
- Confirm holiday calendar and working-hour requirements.
- Confirm the final leave administration process and system/reference format.
- Confirm the applicable statutory framework and location-specific requirements.
- Insert HR contact details.
- Constitute and insert Internal Committee/POSH contact details.
- Confirm emergency and security escalation contacts.
- Confirm any benefits that the Company wishes to communicate in a separate benefits document.
- Review travel limits and reimbursement workflow.
- Confirm employee referral payment administration and tax treatment.
- Obtain Management approval and document version number/effective date.
- Communicate the handbook to employees and obtain acknowledgements.
- Schedule the next formal policy review.

Final Disclaimer

This handbook is an internal policy document of Aurigin Media. It is intended as a practical guide to employment practices and workplace standards and does not by itself create a guarantee of employment or a contractual entitlement beyond the employee's applicable employment documents and mandatory law. Aurigin Media reserves the right to review, amend, replace, suspend or withdraw policies as permitted by applicable law and business requirements.

Term	Meaning
Aurigin Media / Company	Aurigin Media, the legal/company name used in this handbook.
Employee	A person engaged by Aurigin Media under an applicable employment arrangement.
Manager	The person responsible for supervising, assigning work to, or managing an employee.
Client	A customer, brand, organization or business for whom Aurigin Media provides services.
Client Account	Any social, advertising, digital, analytics, communication or platform account operated or accessed for a client.
Confidential Information	Non-public Company, employee, client, creator, vendor, commercial, financial, creative, technical or operational information.
Personal Data	Information relating to an identified or identifiable individual, as applicable under law.
Work Product	Materials, creative, copy, designs, strategies, reports, documents, concepts or other output created in connection with Company work.
Business Day	A day on which Aurigin Media is scheduled to conduct normal business, excluding applicable weekly holidays and declared holidays.

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25 AURIGIN MEDIA AGENCY PROFESSIONAL STANDARDS

Because Aurigin Media operates across social media, digital marketing, creative and influencer marketing, employees are expected to apply both general workplace standards and agency-specific professional discipline.

25.1 Client Servicing

- Treat client commitments as professional commitments. Confirm deliverables, owners and timelines rather than making assumptions.
- Do not commit the Company to additional scope, cost, publication dates or commercial terms without appropriate authorization.
- Record material client decisions, approvals and changes through the designated work channel.
- Escalate risks early where a deadline, quality standard, approval or client expectation may be missed.
- Do not argue with or respond defensively to a client in a manner that could damage the relationship; escalate difficult situations appropriately.

25.2 Creative & Content

- Work from the approved brief and applicable brand guidelines.
- Use version control so that the current approved creative can be identified.
- Check spelling, grammar, factual claims, brand names, handles, links, dates, offers and mandatory disclosures before submission or publication.
- Do not reuse an asset from another client or project unless the necessary rights and approvals exist.
- Where a deliverable requires client approval, do not treat an internal draft as final.

25.3 Social Media & Community Management

- Verify platform, account, caption, creative, tagging, links, timing and audience settings before publishing.
- Community responses should follow the approved tone of voice and escalation matrix.
- Do not delete, hide, edit or respond to sensitive comments outside authorized procedures.
- Potential legal, safety, reputational or crisis-related comments should be escalated rather than improvised.

25.4 Influencer / Creator Engagement

- Treat creator commercial terms, rates, contact information and deliverables as confidential.
- Do not make personal commitments, side arrangements, commissions or benefits with creators or their representatives.
- Ensure deliverables, timelines, usage rights, disclosure requirements and approval expectations are documented.
- Escalate missed deliverables, disputes, payment issues or material creator concerns promptly.

25.5 Digital Marketing & Reporting

- Do not manipulate, conceal or misstate campaign performance data.
- Protect advertising account credentials, budgets, payment information and analytics access.
- Reports should accurately distinguish actual performance from estimates, projections or assumptions.
- Material errors in campaign settings, budgets or reporting must be escalated immediately.

25.6 Client Meetings & Representation

- Be prepared, punctual and appropriately professional for client meetings, shoots, events and presentations.
- Employees representing Aurigin Media externally must protect confidential information and use only approved Company/client information.
- Do not make public commitments or statements outside your authority.

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26 DETAILED POSH & GRIEVANCE PROCEDURE

Aurigin Media is committed to maintaining a workplace in which employees can raise concerns without fear of retaliation. Sexual harassment matters will be handled through the mechanism required by applicable law and the Company's Internal Committee, where applicable.

26.1 What May Constitute Sexual Harassment

- Unwelcome physical contact or advances.
- Demand or request for sexual favours.
- Sexually coloured remarks, jokes or comments.
- Showing or circulating sexually explicit or offensive material.
- Unwelcome communication or conduct of a sexual nature, including through digital channels.
- Other unwelcome verbal, non-verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature covered by applicable law.

26.2 Reporting

- An employee may approach the designated Internal Committee/contact using the communicated official channel.
- Complaints should be made within the time period prescribed by applicable law, subject to any permitted extension.
- Employees should preserve relevant messages, emails, screenshots or other evidence where safe and appropriate.

26.3 Confidentiality

- Information relating to a complaint, parties, proceedings and outcome will be handled confidentially to the extent required by law.
- Employees must not circulate allegations, evidence or investigation material on social media, messaging groups or other unauthorized channels.

26.4 Investigation & Interim Measures

- The authorized committee/process may hear the parties, review evidence and obtain relevant information in accordance with applicable law.
- Where necessary and lawful, interim arrangements may be considered to protect the parties and preserve a fair workplace.

26.5 Retaliation

- Retaliation, intimidation or victimization against a complainant, respondent or witness for participating in a good-faith process is prohibited.
- Knowingly making a malicious complaint may be addressed through appropriate process; a complaint that cannot be substantiated is not, by itself, a malicious complaint.

26.6 General Grievances

- Employees may raise non-POSH employment concerns with HR, their manager or an appropriate senior leader.
- HR will assess the concern, determine the appropriate route and maintain appropriate records.
- Employees should first use internal channels where reasonably practicable, without limiting any statutory right to approach an external authority.

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27 DETAILED DISCIPLINARY & CORRECTIVE ACTION PROCEDURE

Disciplinary action is intended to address misconduct fairly, protect the workplace and maintain professional standards. The process applied will depend on the nature and seriousness of the matter and applicable law.

27.1 Initial Assessment

- HR/Management may review the concern, relevant records and immediate risk.
- Where appropriate, the employee may be asked for an initial explanation.
- Interim measures may be taken where necessary to protect people, data, clients, assets or the integrity of an investigation.

27.2 Show Cause Notice

- Where warranted, the Company may issue a written notice setting out the concern and asking the employee to explain.
- The employee should provide a truthful response within the stated timeline.

27.3 Formal Enquiry

- Where required by the circumstances or applicable law, a formal domestic enquiry may be conducted.
- The employee will be given the opportunity to present their explanation and relevant evidence as required by the process.
- Records of the proceedings will be maintained appropriately.

27.4 Corrective Measures

- Counselling or coaching.
- Written warning.
- Mandatory training.
- Performance or conduct improvement plan.
- Suspension or other interim action where appropriate and lawful.
- Termination or other separation action.

27.5 Gross / Serious Misconduct

- Fraud, theft or deliberate financial falsification.
- Unauthorized access, credential theft or serious data breach.
- Intentional disclosure of client confidential information.
- Serious harassment, violence or threats.
- Deliberate destruction or misuse of Company/client assets.
- Serious insubordination or conduct causing material reputational or commercial harm.

27.6 Documentation

- Material disciplinary actions should be documented and retained securely.
- Employees may be required to acknowledge receipt of formal communications; acknowledgement does not necessarily mean agreement.

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28 INFORMATION SECURITY & CLIENT ACCOUNT CONTROL MATRIX

The following minimum controls apply to digital work. Client-specific security requirements may be stricter and must be followed.

Area	Minimum Standard	Employee Responsibility	Escalation
Credentials	Authorized access only; no sharing	Protect passwords, OTPs and recovery information	Immediately on exposure/suspicious access
Publishing	Approved content + authorized user	Complete checks before publishing	Immediately on incorrect publication
Client Data	Need-to-know access	No personal storage or unauthorized forwarding	Immediately on accidental disclosure
Devices	Screen lock + security controls	Protect devices and report loss	Immediately on loss/theft
Third-Party Tools	Use only where permitted	Review data handling before uploading work	Ask HR/Management where unclear
Offboarding	Access removal + handover	Transfer/return credentials and assets	Before final working day

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